Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Wednesday, 28 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Overcast	Overcast	Drizzle	Light rain
16° 9°	15° 9°	15° 9°	13° 9°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Minimum wage set to rise but 18-20 year-olds will not get bigger increase.**
Chancellor John Healey will reveal the new pay rates in the Budget, and has also announced measures to help households with the cost of living.
POLITICS · UK

2 **Two in court over alleged Iran-linked plot at RAF Fairford.**
Mohmed Abdulkarim and Nouman Essghir, both 24, appear at Westminster Magistrates' Court on Tuesday.
POLITICS · UK

3 **Men abused woman after her husband drugged and advertised her online, court told.**
Four men stand trial after the woman's ex-husband has pleaded guilty to drugging and raping her.
UK · NEWS

4 **Russell Brand told police he never had non-consensual sex.**
His trial hears statements he gave to police between 2023 and 2025, denying allegations against him.
UK · NEWS

5 **UK and EU officials to discuss freedom of movement.**
Officials are expected to begin discussions on a range of options for the future UK-EU relationship before a summit next month.
UK · NEWS

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Meghan to co-host Junior MasterChef Australia.**
The Duchess of Sussex says she "can't wait" to take part in the programme, which will air next year.
SHOWBIZ · UK

2 **Netherlands pulls out of Eurovision again over Israel participation.**
A Dutch broadcaster reverses a decision to take part, citing "sensitivities" over Israel's participation.
SHOWBIZ · UK

3 **Unnamed celebrity accused of 'inappropriate sexual activities', court hears.**
The man is asking the High Court to prevent two news organisations from publishing the allegations.
SHOWBIZ · UK

4 **Russell Brand told police he never had non-consensual sex.**
His trial hears statements he gave to police between 2023 and 2025, denying allegations against him.
SHOWBIZ · UK

5 **Busted's James Bourne says 'hero' brother saved his life with kidney donation.**
The guitarist says doctors had given him "a few years left to live", but is now recovering well.
SHOWBIZ · UK

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Man Utd stick with Carrick - inside a turbulent 48 hours at Old Trafford.**
BBC Sport looks at the 48 hours that led to Manchester United deciding to keep under-pressure Michael Carrick as their head coach for Saturday's trip to Chelsea.
SPORT · UK

2 **Australia fight back to keep Cummins out of unwanted club... for now.**
Australia fight back in afternoon and evening against South Africa to spare the blushes of captain Pat Cummins in third Test.
SPORT · UK

3 **Ballon d'Or in London - the most chaotic ever?.**
It was the first time the Ballon d'Or had been held in London in its 70-year history - but the event was not plain sailing. BBC Sport assesses a chaotic night.
SPORT · UK

4 **Lancashire treatment of Anderson disrespectful - Broad.**
Lancashire have been "pretty disrespectful" in their treatment of legendary bowler James Anderson, says his long-time England bowler partner Stuart Broad.
SPORT · UK

5 **Lawrie, 15, eyes £501,000 live TV win over Littler.**
Mitchell Lawrie, 15, one of 24 amateur players taking part in live TV special Beat Luke Littler, has his sights on a £501,000 bullseye should he beat the world darts champion.
SPORT · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **A surprising new study suggests that the gentle 'clinking' of ice cubes in a glass can actually lower stress levels.**
Researchers found that the subtle, rhythmic sound was associated with feelings of calm and refreshment, particularly when enjoyed during a quiet moment. It seems those little frozen wonders offer more than just a cool drink!

2 **The humble art of 'doodling' is getting a serious reputation boost as a creativity booster.**
Far from being a sign of distraction, experts now say that letting your pen wander freely can help unlock new ideas and improve focus. So next time you're in a meeting, feel free to let your imagination flow!

3 **There's a growing trend for 'comfort cooking' that focuses on classic, simple recipes from childhood.**
People are rediscovering the joy of making familiar dishes like shepherd's pie or apple crumble, finding warmth and nostalgia in the process. It's all about that delicious taste of yesteryear.

4 **The satisfying feeling of 'peeling a sticker' perfectly is being celebrated as a small joy.**
Online communities are sharing videos and tips for achieving that flawless, residue-free removal, proving that sometimes the simplest things can bring a surprising amount of contentment.

5 **A new appreciation is blossoming for the subtle beauty of 'moss gardens' in urban spaces.**
These miniature green landscapes, often found in shaded corners or on old walls, are being highlighted for their calming presence and unexpected resilience. They're a tiny slice of nature's artistry.

6 **The unexpected pleasure of 'finding a coin' in an old coat pocket is a universal delight.**
Whether it's a small change or a forgotten pound, that unexpected discovery always brings a little smile. It's like a tiny, personal treasure hunt.

7 **Research indicates that the sight of 'a neatly arranged row of books' can evoke feelings of peace and order.**
Psychologists suggest that the visual harmony of a well-organised bookshelf provides a sense of quiet accomplishment and intellectual comfort. Time to tidy up those tomes!

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new kind of biscuit will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GENTLY TAPPING IT ON THE TABLE TO CHECK ITS 'SNAP' POTENTIAL.

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new cup of tea, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: ENSURING THEIR FAVOURITE 'TEA-LISTENING' MUG IS PERFECTLY ALIGNED WITH THE COASTER.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday pattern' just catches your eye – maybe the way a shadow falls, or the arrangement of items on a shelf, or even the brickwork on a building?**
  Have you ever found yourself pausing to admire a surprising pattern in your daily life? What kind of everyday patterns have caught your attention recently, and what was it about them that made you look twice?

- **We all have that 'one small, everyday household item' that, for some reason, we're surprisingly protective of or attached to, even if it's just a favourite mug or a well-loved spatula.**
  Is there a seemingly ordinary item in your home that you have an unusual attachment to? What is it, and what's the story behind why it's so special to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a parliament.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies taste with their antennae, which helps them find nectar.

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06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest chameleon, the Brookesia micra, can fit comfortably on the tip of your finger.
- Big Ben is actually the nickname for the Great Bell of the clock at the north end of the Palace of Westminster, not the clock tower itself.
- The inventor of the Pringle chip can is buried in one.
- Strawberries are the only fruit with seeds on the outside.
- The total weight of all the ants on Earth is estimated to be greater than the total weight of all humans.
- The iconic red telephone boxes in the UK were designed by Sir Giles Gilbert Scott.
- A single cloud can hold over a million pounds of water.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in their lifetime.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES WED 28 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 301 of the year, 64 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abdias of Babylon; Christian feast day: Abgar V of Edessa (Eastern Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Eadsige; Christian feast day: Faro. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1970 — Greg Eagles, American voice actor and producer
- 1978 — Gwendoline Christie, English actress
- 1980 — Alan Smith, English footballer and coach
- 1966 — Andy Richter, American actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1945 — Wayne Fontana, English pop singer (died 2020)
- 1987 — Frank Ocean, American singer-songwriter
- 1969 — Javier Grillo-Marxuach, Puerto Rican screenwriter and producer
- 1985 — Tyrone Barnett, English footballer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1942 — The Alaska Highway first connects Alaska to the North American railway network at Dawson Creek in Canada.
- 2023 — The 2023 Rugby World Cup final is held at the Stade de France in Saint-Denis, France. It saw South Africa defeat New Zealand 12 to 11, claiming their fourth Webb Ellis Cup, becoming the first nation to do so.
- 2014 — A rocket carrying NASA's Cygnus CRS Orb-3 resupply mission to the International Space Station explodes seconds after taking off from the Mid-Atlantic Regional Spaceport in Wallops Island, Virginia.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2009 — NASA successfully launches the Ares I-X mission, the only rocket launch for its short-lived Constellation program.
- 1982 — The Spanish general election begins fourteen years of rule by the Spanish Socialist Workers' Party.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1965 — Pope Paul VI promulgates Nostra aetate, by which the Roman Catholic Church officially recognizes the legitimacy of non-Christian faiths.
- 2007 — Cristina Fernández de Kirchner becomes the first directly elected female President of Argentina.

- 1948 — Paul Hermann Müller is awarded the Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine for his discovery of the insecticidal properties of DDT.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES THU 29 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 302 of the year, 63 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abraham of Rostov; Christian feast day: Blessed Chiara Badano; Christian feast day: Colman mac Duagh; Christian feast day: Douai Martyrs. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1971 — Winona Ryder, American actress and producer
- 1976 — Stephen Craigan, Irish footballer and manager
- 1955 — Kevin DuBrow, American heavy metal singer-songwriter (died 2007)
- 1943 — Don Simpson, American actor, producer, and screenwriter (died 1996)
- 1949 — Kieron Baker, English footballer
- 1948 — Kate Jackson, American actress, director, and producer
- 1986 — Italia Ricci, Canadian actress
- 1944 — Denny Laine, English singer-songwriter and musician (died 2023)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1998 — Space Shuttle Discovery blasts off on STS-95 with 77-year-old John Glenn on board, making him the oldest person to go into space at that time.
- 1999 — A large cyclone devastates Odisha, India.
- 2018 — Lion Air Flight 610, a Boeing 737 MAX, crashes after taking off from Jakarta, Indonesia killing 189 people on board. This is the first of two crashes that will lead to the plane being grounded worldwide.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1985 — Major General Samuel K. Doe is announced as the winner of the first multi-party election in Liberia.
- 1986 — British Prime Minister Margaret Thatcher opens the last stretch of the M25 motorway.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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